

See also: INTERPOL 220–221 ■ The International Criminal Court 298–303
 ■ The International Convention Against Doping in Sport 304

Sports is a target for **betting syndicates** everywhere, and the **possibilities for match fixing** are clear.

Southeast Asia sees a huge expansion in match-fixing **crime syndicates**.

As sports becomes a **global industry**, the **rewards for illicit betting** grow.

Law enforcement agencies worldwide **share intelligence** to help battle criminal organizations.

Cross-border investigation has achieved some **success against match fixing**.

of a game—unrelated to the final result—is called spot fixing and can involve huge sums of money.

Working with a global network of law enforcement agencies, the IMFTF shares intelligence and provides a platform for cross-border investigations. In one success story, Dan Tan (see box, right) was arrested and detained in Singapore. In 2011, FIFA, the international governing body of soccer, agreed to grant millions of euros to INTERPOL for an anti-corruption training program. But FIFA was itself rocked by scandal, with charges of corruption against many of its top officials—including its president, Sepp Blatter—and allegations of bribery

focused on the bidding process that led to FIFA awarding the hosting of the 2022 World Cup to Qatar.

The extent to which any organization could hope to end corruption on such a scale is limited, and online betting has made gambling even more attractive to criminals. Yet by reaching across borders, INTERPOL has had some success in stemming the problem. ■

The Kelong King

Born in Singapore in 1964, Tan Seet Eng, also known as Dan Tan, was once described by INTERPOL as “the leader of the world’s most notorious match-fixing syndicate.” Widely known as the “Kelong King” (“Cheating King”), Tan is alleged to have started match fixing in Singapore in the early 1990s, working with an associate, Wilson Raj Perumal, and was briefly jailed for illegal bookmaking. By 2010, Italian soccer had allegedly become his target, with games fixed in conjunction with crime rings in Eastern Europe.

Tan and Perumal were also alleged to have fixed matches in Hungary, Nigeria, and Finland. In 2011, Perumal was arrested in Finland and denounced Tan, claiming that he was the ringleader of a global match-fixing network. In 2013, Tan was arrested by Singapore police under the terms of a local law and detained with no formal charges. Released in December 2019, he still faces charges in Italy and Hungary. He has denied any wrongdoing.

South African cricket captain

“Hansie” Cronje (foreground) was barred from the sport for life in 2000 after admitting to match fixing. He died in a plane crash in 2002.

